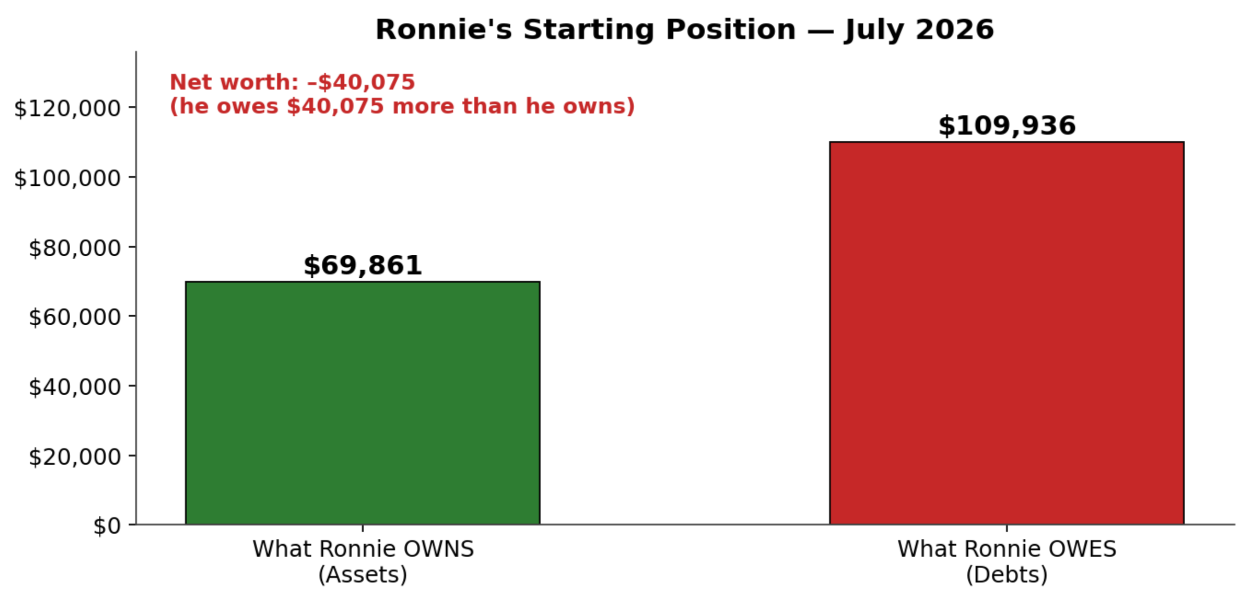
Roadmap to Debt-Free

Prepared for Ronnie (age 34, veteran, Washington State) — Alber Joe's Financial Advising — July 18, 2026

The goal: Ronnie wants to become **completely debt-free as fast as possible** so he can marry his girlfriend. This roadmap shows exactly what to sell, which debts to pay, in what order, and what happens each month — with no guesswork. **Bottom line: following this plan, Ronnie pays off all $109,936 of debt in about 22 months and is debt-free around May 2028.** The first big step happens this week and eliminates roughly 37% of the debt in a single day.

Snapshot — July 2026	Amount
Total assets (everything Ronnie owns)	$69,861
Total debts (everything Ronnie owes)	$109,936
Net worth (assets minus debts)	**–$40,075**
Take-home income per month (after estimated taxes)	≈ $7,957
Living costs per month (kept exactly as-is, per Ronnie)	$4,300
Available to attack debt each month	$3,400 (+ $257 safety cushion)
Projected debt-free date	**≈ May 2028 (22 months)**



Section 1 — Where Ronnie Stands Today

Every number below comes directly from the documents Ronnie provided. Many files were mislabeled (for example, the file named “Discover” actually shows the student loan), so each item was matched by the **contents** of the document, not its file name. Investment values use the prices supplied with the file package (quoted as of July 13, 2026).

1.1 Assets — what Ronnie owns: $69,861 total

Cash and property. Ronnie holds $5,967 across cash and bank accounts, plus a car worth $22,000. **Ronnie has stated he will not sell the car, so it stays and is never touched in this plan.**

Item	Value	Notes
Cash	$1,000	Available immediately
Checking account	$1,967	Available immediately
Savings account	$3,000	Available immediately
Car	$22,000	NOT for sale (Ronnie’s instruction) — excluded from the payoff plan
Subtotal	**$27,967**	

Individual stocks (Fidelity brokerage — Ronnie bought these himself). Ten purchases across eight companies. Values = shares held × current price provided. “Long-term” means held over one year, which matters for taxes (lower tax rate).

Stock	Bought	Cost	Shares	Price now	Value now	Gain / loss	Tax status
SanDisk (SNDK)	Jul 16, 2025	$350	7.78	$1,749	$13,607	+$13,257	Long-term
Western Digital (WDC)	Aug 13, 2025	$650	9.03	$563	$5,084	+$4,434	Short-term
Micron (MU)	Jul 16, 2025	$400	3.48	$955	$3,323	+$2,923	Long-term
AMD	Apr 6, 2024	$1,000	5.88	$558	$3,281	+$2,281	Long-term
Apple (AAPL)	Dec 30, 2022	$900	6.98	$314	$2,192	+$1,292	Long-term
NVIDIA (NVDA)	Jan 30, 2026	$900	6.92	$208	$1,439	+$539	Short-term
Palantir (PLTR)	Aug 13, 2025	$1,400	8.92	$128	$1,142	–$258	Short-term
Tesla (TSLA)	Jul 9, 2025	$772	2.57	$395	$1,015	+$243	Long-term
NVIDIA (NVDA)	Aug 13, 2025	$799	4.39	$208	$913	+$114	Short-term
Tesla (TSLA)	Sep 15, 2022	$225	0.74	$395	$292	+$67	Long-term
Subtotal		**$7,396**			**$32,289**	**+$24,893**	

S&P 500 index fund. Eight small purchases made between 2017 and 2025, totaling 1.1262 index shares. At the provided index level of 7,515.34 (July 13, 2026 close), the position is worth **$8,464** (cost $3,847; gain +$4,617; all long-term).

Purchased	Mar 2017	Dec 2017	Feb 2018	Oct 2018	Jan 2020	Feb 2021	Aug 2023	Jul 2025	**Total**
Invested	$250	$423	$400	$378	$662	$488	$569	$677	**$3,847**
Index shares	0.1049	0.1609	0.1527	0.1366	0.2053	0.1268	0.1302	0.1088	**1.1262**

Cryptocurrency. Four coins worth **$1,142** in total today (cost $1,525 — an overall loss of $383, which actually *reduces* Ronnie's tax bill when sold).

Coin	Bought	Cost	Holdings	Price now	Value now	Gain / loss
Ethereum (ETH)	May 2, 2023	$500	0.267	$1,760	$470	–$30
Bitcoin (BTC)	Jan 11, 2025	$500	0.00532	$63,042.54	$335	–$165
Hedera (HBAR)	Mar 10, 2023	$200	3,226	$0.068	$219	+$19
Cosmos (ATOM)	Apr 5, 2025	$325	76.47	$1.53	$117	–$208
Subtotal		**$1,525**			**$1,142**	**–$383**

ASSET TOTALS	Value
Cash + bank accounts	$5,967
Car (not for sale)	$22,000
Individual stocks	$32,289
S&P 500 index fund	$8,464
Cryptocurrency	$1,142
TOTAL ASSETS	**$69,861**

1.2 Debts — what Ronnie owes: $109,936 total

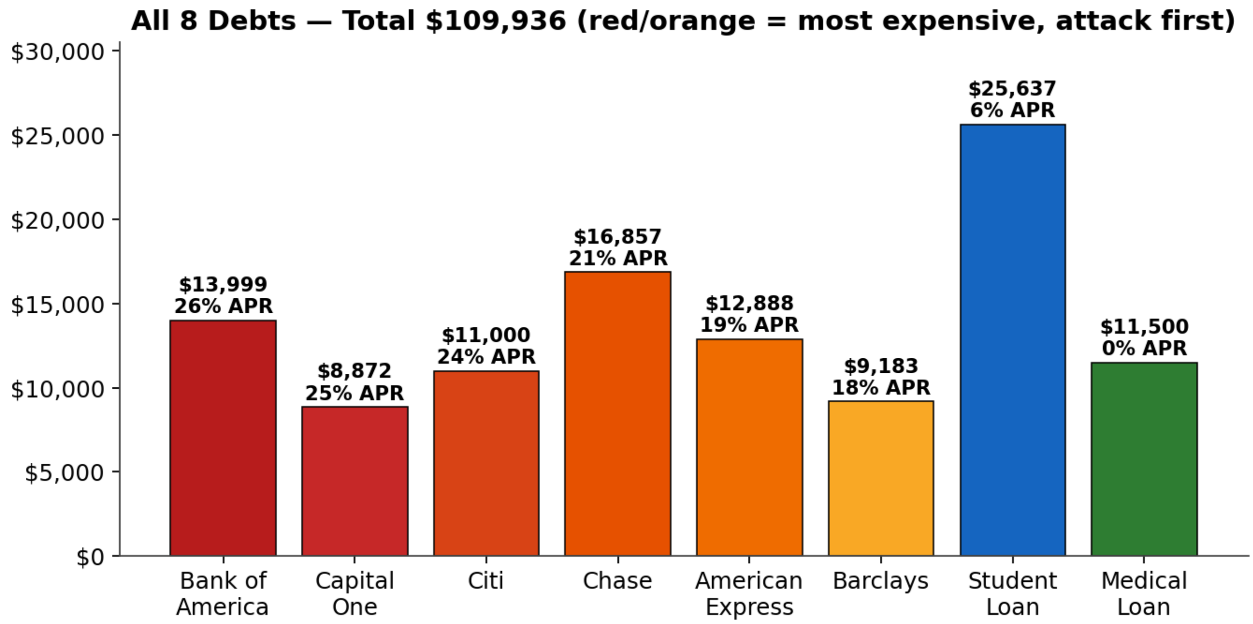
Ronnie has **eight active debts**: six credit cards, one student loan, and one medical loan. "APR" is the yearly interest rate — the price Ronnie pays for carrying the debt. Right now these debts are charging him about **$1,473 in interest every single month** ($17,678 per year) — money that buys him nothing.

#	Debt	Balance	APR	Required monthly minimum	Monthly interest cost
1	Bank of America credit card	$13,999	26%	$440	$303
2	Capital One credit card	$8,872	25%	Not provided (see flags)	$185
3	Citi credit card	$11,000	24%	Not provided (see flags)	$220
4	Chase credit card	$16,857	21%	$279	$295
5	American Express credit card	$12,888	19%	$330	$204
6	Barclays credit card	$9,183	18%	Not provided (see flags)	$138
7	Student loan	$25,637	6%	$500	$128
8	Medical debt loan	$11,500	0%	Not provided (see flags)	$0
	TOTAL DEBT	**$109,936**		**$1,549 (across the four listed)**	≈ **$1,473**

Items reviewed and excluded from Ronnie's debt total:

- **Synchrony ($9,240) and U.S. Bank ($12,122):** the document is stamped "Paid in Full: 12/20/2024." These are old, settled accounts — not current debts.
- **Discover card, $6,792 at 18% APR:** the document is labeled "Ronnie's Girlfriend." This is **her** debt, not his. Her condition is that *Ronnie* be debt-free, so it is excluded from his plan (flagged in Section 4 for the advisor to confirm).

- **Speeding ticket:** paid in full on 1/29/2023 — no longer owed.



1.3 Income — what comes in: $108,000 per year before taxes

Income source	Per year	Per month	Taxed?
Job salary (stated as pre-tax)	$72,000	$6,000	Yes — federal income tax + payroll tax
VA disability (veteran benefit)	$36,000	$3,000	No — VA disability is tax-free by federal law
Total income (gross)	**$108,000**	**$9,000**	
Estimated taxes on the salary (federal + payroll; Washington has no state income tax)	–$12,518	–$1,043	
TAKE-HOME INCOME (estimated)	**≈ $95,482**	**≈ $7,957**	

Tax estimate: single filer, 2026 federal brackets, standard deduction $16,100 → federal income tax ≈ $7,010 plus Social Security/Medicare ≈ $5,508. Washington State has no state income tax. Actual paycheck withholding may differ slightly; the plan's $257 monthly cushion absorbs small differences.

Section 2 — Financial Health Check

RATING: PROBLEMATIC (scale: Healthy → Manageable → **Problematic** → Dire)

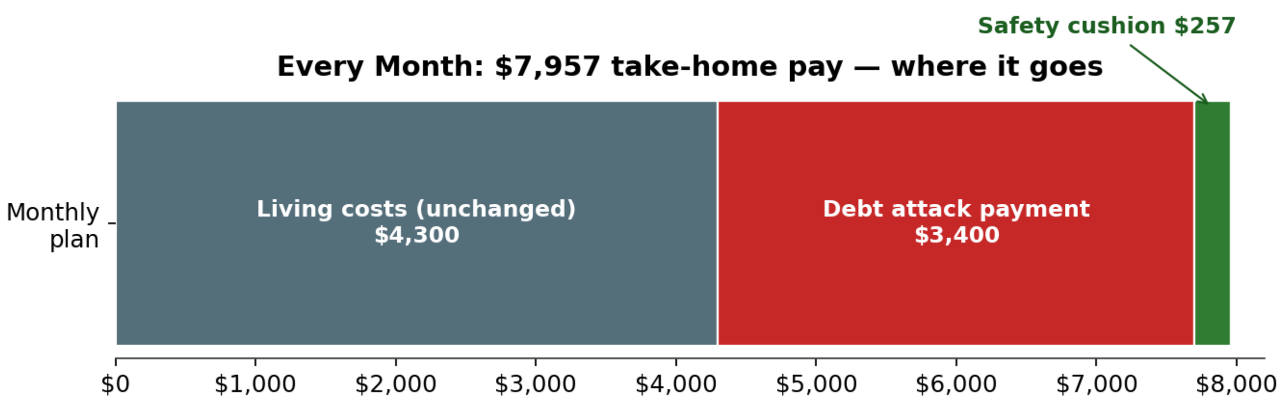
Why "Problematic" and not better

- **Ronnie owes more than he owns.** Debts ($109,936) exceed assets ($69,861) by $40,075. His net worth is negative.
- **The debt is expensive and growing fast.** $72,799 of it sits on six credit cards charging 18–26% interest. That bleeds ≈ $1,473/month in pure interest — more than his rent, groceries, and utilities margin combined could ever out-earn through investing.
- **The debt equals a full year of gross income.** Total debt is 102% of his $108,000 annual income — well above the level where debt is considered comfortably serviceable.
- **His investments cannot keep up with his interest.** His entire $41,894 portfolio would need to earn roughly 42% per year just to match what the debt charges him. No safe investment does that.

Why "Problematic" and not "Dire"

- **Income is strong and stable.** After taxes and all living costs, Ronnie clears roughly $3,657 every month — a genuinely large surplus. $3,000/month of his income is tax-free VA disability, which is very secure.
- **He is current on his bills.** Nothing in the documents indicates missed payments, collections, or wage garnishment.
- **He has real assets to deploy.** Nearly $42,000 in investments plus $5,967 in cash can erase over a third of the debt immediately.
- **The math works.** With the surplus he already has — no lifestyle cuts required — every debt can be gone in under two years. A "Dire" situation is one with no realistic path out; Ronnie has a clear one.

In one sentence: Ronnie is in a hole, and the hole is getting deeper by $1,473 every month he waits — but he has both the shovel-stopper (his investments) and the ladder (his income surplus) to climb out fast. Acting immediately is what keeps this "Problematic" instead of letting it slide toward "Dire."



Section 3 — The Roadmap: Debt-Free in 22 Months

About the timeline. Ronnie's requested timeline is "as soon as possible." The plan below **is** the fastest realistic path given his income, his budget (which he asked us not to change), and his car (which he asked us not to sell): **all $109,936 paid off in about 22 months — debt-free around May 2028**, most likely sooner if tax refunds, raises, or any windfalls are thrown at the debt.

The strategy in plain words

1) **Sell every investment now and fire that money at the most expensive debts.** Paying off a 26% credit card is mathematically identical to earning a guaranteed, tax-free 26% return — no stock or coin reliably does that. Keeping the investments while carrying these cards means losing money every month. 2) **Then use the monthly surplus ($3,400) to knock out the remaining debts one at a time, always attacking the highest interest rate first** (the "avalanche" method — it is the cheapest and fastest order because expensive debt is eliminated before it can grow). 3) **The 0% medical loan goes last** — it charges nothing to wait, so every dollar aimed at it early would be a dollar not saving 18–21% elsewhere.

What gets sold — and what does not

Item	Decision	Why
All 10 stock positions ($32,289)	**SELL now**	Converts to guaranteed 18–26% "returns" by killing card debt. SNDK alone ($13,607) is up ~39× on cost and is dangerously concentrated — one bad week could erase thousands.
S&P 500 index fund ($8,464)	**SELL now**	Historically earns ~7–10%/yr — far less than the 18–26% the cards charge. Holding it while in card debt loses money on average.
Crypto ($1,142)	**SELL now**	Sitting at a $383 overall loss; selling locks in a tax deduction that offsets gains from the stock sales, and removes high-volatility exposure.
Cash & bank accounts ($5,967)	**USE $3,967; KEEP $2,000**	$2,000 stays as an emergency cushion so a surprise expense (car repair, medical bill) goes to cash — not back onto a credit card. Advisor judgment call; flagged in Section 4.
Car ($22,000)	**KEEP — never sold**	Ronnie explicitly refused to sell it. The plan reaches debt-free without it.

Taxes on the sales (do not skip this): selling triggers capital gains tax, due with the 2026 tax return in April 2027. Estimated bill: long-term gains ≈ $24,297 × 15% ≈ $3,645, plus short-term gains ≈ $4,829 taxed like salary at 22% ≈ $1,062 — ≈ **$4,707 total. The plan sets aside $4,800 on day one** so this bill is already covered and can never derail the schedule.

STEP 1 — This week (late July 2026): raise the cash

Action	Cash raised
Sell all stocks in the Fidelity account (all 10 positions)	$32,289
Sell the S&P 500 index fund position	$8,464
Sell all cryptocurrency (ETH, BTC, HBAR, ATOM)	$1,142
Withdraw spare cash from savings/checking/cash (keeping $2,000 emergency fund)	$3,967
Set aside tax reserve for April 2027 capital-gains bill (park in savings)	–$4,800
TOTAL AVAILABLE TO PAY DEBT ON DAY 1	**$41,061**

STEP 2 — Same week: the Day-1 knockout (pay in this exact order)

Order	Pay	Amount	Why this one	Cash left
1st	Bank of America card — **PAID OFF**	$13,999	Highest rate (26%) = the most expensive debt he owes	$27,062
2nd	Capital One card — **PAID OFF**	$8,872	Next-highest rate (25%)	$18,190
3rd	Citi card — **PAID OFF**	$11,000	Next-highest rate (24%)	$7,190
4th	Chase card — partial payment	$7,190	Next-highest rate (21%); every remaining dollar goes here	$0
	DEBT REMAINING AFTER DAY 1	**$68,875**	**Down from $109,936 — 37% of the debt gone in one day**	

Chase drops to **$9,667**. The Day-1 knockout alone cuts Ronnie's interest bleed from ≈ $1,473/month to ≈ $639/month — an instant saving of about **$834 every month** before he has changed a single habit. (Once a card is at $0, it can be kept open or closed: keeping it open at $0 helps his credit score; closing it removes temptation. Advisor's call — either way, no new charges.)

STEP 3 — Every month starting August 2026: the $3,400 debt attack

Take-home pay ≈ $7,957. Living costs stay **exactly** as Ronnie runs them today — $4,300, not one line changed, per his instruction. That leaves $3,657. **$3,400 goes to debt every month; $257 stays as the safety cushion** (the plan requirement is at least $200 of wiggle room — this clears it). The $3,400 first covers the required minimum payments on every open debt, and every remaining dollar piles onto the highest-rate debt still standing:

Target order	Debt (rate)	Paid off by	Rationale
Target #1	Chase ($9,667 left, 21%)	Dec 2026	Highest rate still alive after Day 1
Target #2	American Express ($12,888, 19%)	Apr 2027	Next most expensive
Target #3	Barclays ($9,183, 18%)	Aug 2027	Next most expensive
Target #4	Student loan ($25,637, 6%)	Feb 2028	Cheap debt — but must hit $0 to be debt-free
Target #5	Medical loan ($11,500, 0%)	May 2028	Charges nothing to wait, so it goes last at zero cost

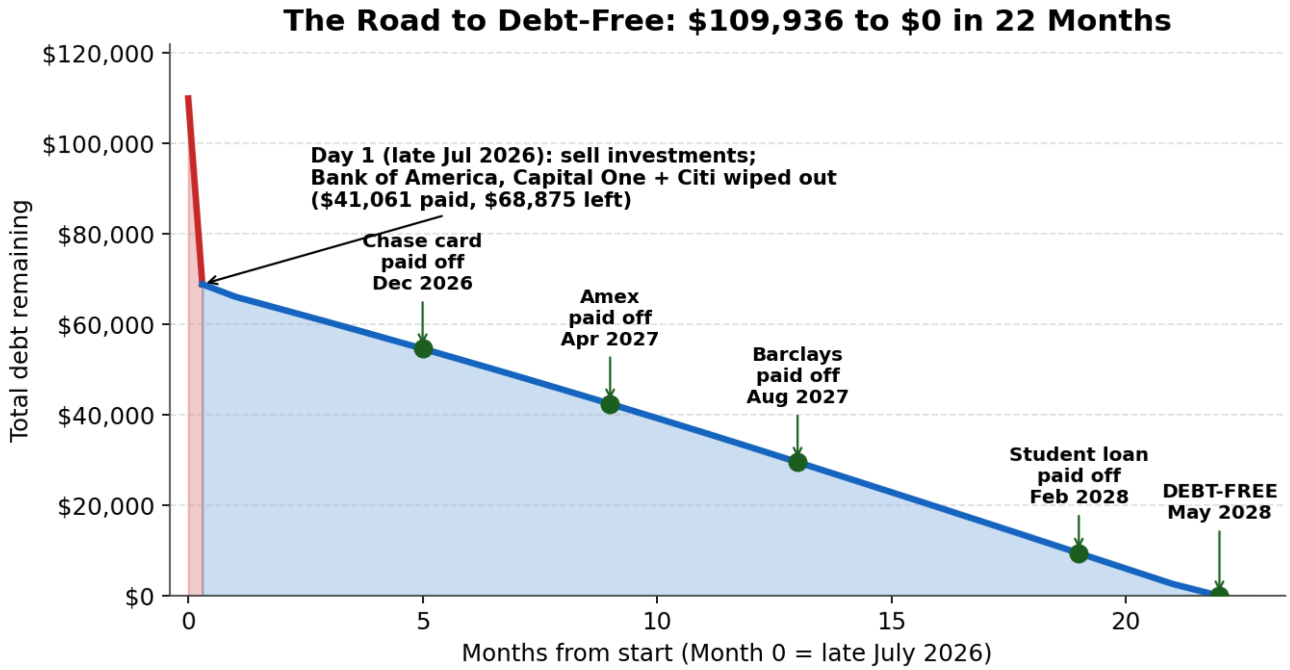
April 2027 (during Target #2): pay the ≈ $4,707 capital-gains tax bill using the $4,800 reserve parked in savings on Day 1. It is already funded — the monthly plan does not pause. Any leftover from the reserve (~$93) goes straight at the current target debt.

The full schedule, month by month

Balances shown are end-of-month after each $3,400 payment, including interest as it accrues. Dates assume the sell-off completes in late July 2026.

Month	Date	Chase 21%	Amex 19%	Barclays 18%	Student 6%	Medical 0%	Total left
Day 1	Jul 2026	$9,667	$12,888	$9,183	$25,637	$11,500	$68,875
1	Aug 2026	$7,450	$12,762	$9,137	$25,265	$11,500	$66,114
2	Sep 2026	$5,194	$12,634	$9,090	$24,892	$11,500	$63,310
3	Oct 2026	$2,899	$12,504	$9,042	$24,516	$11,500	$60,461
4	Nov 2026	$564	$12,372	$8,994	$24,139	$11,500	$57,569
5	Dec 2026	PAID ✓	$10,426	$8,945	$23,759	$11,500	$54,630
6	Jan 2027	—	$7,875	$8,895	$23,378	$11,500	$51,648
7	Feb 2027	—	$5,283	$8,844	$22,995	$11,500	$48,622
8	Mar 2027	—	$2,651	$8,793	$22,610	$11,500	$45,554
9	Apr 2027	—	PAID ✓	$8,718	$22,223	$11,500	$42,441
10	May 2027	—	—	$5,949	$21,834	$11,500	$39,283
11	Jun 2027	—	—	$3,138	$21,443	$11,500	$36,081
12	Jul 2027	—	—	$285	$21,050	$11,500	$32,835
13	Aug 2027	—	—	PAID ✓	$18,045	$11,500	$29,545
14	Sep 2027	—	—	—	$14,735	$11,500	$26,235
15	Oct 2027	—	—	—	$11,409	$11,500	$22,909
16	Nov 2027	—	—	—	$8,066	$11,500	$19,566
17	Dec 2027	—	—	—	$4,706	$11,500	$16,206
18	Jan 2028	—	—	—	$1,330	$11,500	$12,830
19	Feb 2028	—	—	—	PAID ✓	$9,436	$9,436
20	Mar 2028	—	—	—	—	$6,036	$6,036
21	Apr 2028	—	—	—	—	$2,636	$2,636
22	**May 2028**	**—**	**—**	**—**	**—**	**PAID ✓**	**$0 DEBT-FREE**

Required minimums are always paid on every open account (Chase $279, Amex $330, student loan $500; Barclays' minimum was not documented and is modeled at ≈ $184 — see flags). Total interest paid over the whole 22-month plan: ≈ **$5,162**. Doing nothing would cost ≈ $17,678 in interest in the first year alone.



Chronological checklist — what Ronnie actually does

When	Action
Week 1 (late Jul 2026)	Place sell orders for all stocks and the index position in Fidelity; sell all crypto. Expect settlement in 1–3 business days.
Week 1	Move $4,800 of the proceeds into savings, labeled “Tax money — do not touch until April 2027.” Keep $2,000 as the emergency fund.
Week 1–2	Call each card for the exact 10-day payoff amount, then pay in order: **Bank of America → Capital One → Citi → rest to Chase.** Get written $0-balance confirmation for each paid-off account.
Aug 2026 onward	Set up automatic payments on the 1st of each month: minimums on every open debt, every remaining dollar of the $3,400 to the current target. Autopay removes willpower from the equation.
Dec 2026	Chase hits $0. Redirect its entire payment to American Express (the payment amount never shrinks — that is what keeps the plan fast).
Apr 2027	File the 2026 tax return; pay the ≈ $4,707 capital-gains bill from the reserve. Throw any tax refund and reserve leftover at Amex/Barclays.
Aug 2027	Cards are all gone. Attack the student loan with the full $3,400 (minimum $500 is absorbed inside it).
Feb 2028	Student loan hits $0. Full $3,400 goes at the 0% medical loan.
≈ May 2028	**Medical loan hits $0. Ronnie is 100% debt-free — and now has $3,657/month free for the wedding, an emergency fund, and rebuilding investments.**

Ronnie’s monthly budget during the plan (unchanged, per his instruction)

Category	Amount	Category	Amount
Rent	$2,300	Gas	$230
Utilities	$250	Subscriptions	$120
Internet	$100	Personal care	$100
Cell phone	$60	Other misc. necessities	$500
Groceries	$490	**LIVING COSTS TOTAL**	**$4,300**
Car insurance	$150	**DEBT ATTACK PAYMENT**	**$3,400**
		SAFETY CUSHION (stays in checking)	**$257**

No budget line was altered — Ronnie stated he is unwilling to change any part of his current budget, and the plan succeeds without touching it. The $257 cushion satisfies the minimum $200 wiggle-room requirement. If a month goes sideways, shrink that month’s debt payment before ever missing a minimum or dipping below the cushion.

Ways the date moves

- **Sooner:** any raise, annual tax refund, overtime, or cash gift aimed at the current target debt. Roughly every extra $3,400 of windfall removes about one month. Negotiating a settlement on the medical debt (often possible) could also shave a month or two.
- **Later:** pausing the attack payment, new credit-card spending (the cards must stay at $0), or a job loss. The $3,000/month VA disability and $2,000 emergency fund are the shock absorbers; even then, minimums must always be paid to protect his credit.

Section 4 — Flags, Inconsistencies & Assumptions (advisor review)

The following items were found while compiling the documents. None change the overall strategy, but each deserves a quick verification before execution.

#	Flag	How it was handled
1	**File names do not match file contents.** “Chase.png” shows an American Express card; “Medical.png” shows the Chase card; “Discover.png” shows the student loan; “Student.png” shows the medical loan; “Crypto.xlsx” holds cash/car; “Assets.xlsx” holds crypto; stock files are similarly shuffled (e.g., “AMD 2.xlsx” is an NVDA purchase).	All data was classified by document **contents** and cross-matched by ticker/lender, not by file name. Totals reconcile cleanly.
2	**Name spelling “Ronny” vs. “Ronnie.”** The chart holding the Capital One, Citi and Barclays cards ($29,055 total) is labeled “Ronny”; every other document says “Ronnie.”	Treated as Ronnie’s debt (most likely a typo) — the safe, conservative choice. **Verify ownership:** if these three cards are not his, he is debt-free ≈ 10 months sooner (~July–Aug 2027).
3	**Girlfriend’s Discover card ($6,792, 18%)** appears in the package labeled “Ronnie’s Girlfriend.”	Excluded — it is her debt and her stated condition concerns Ronnie’s debts only. Flagged so the couple can discuss whether it joins the plan after the wedding.

#	Flag	How it was handled
4	**Synchrony ($9,240) and U.S. Bank ($12,122)** balances appear with a “Paid in Full: 12/20/2024” stamp.	Excluded as settled. Recommend pulling a credit report to confirm they (and the paid 2023 speeding ticket) show closed/paid.
5	**Missing minimum payments.** Minimums were only documented for Chase, Amex, Bank of America and the student loan ($1,549 total). None were found anywhere for Capital One, Citi, Barclays, or the medical loan.	Capital One and Citi are paid off on Day 1, so their minimums never matter. Barclays was modeled at ≈ $184/mo (~2% of balance — industry standard); the medical loan at 0% was modeled with no required minimum. **Confirm both with the lenders;** small differences shift the finish date by at most a month.
6	**Price dates.** Client says prices are “as of today,” but the sheets state July 13, 2026 (report date: July 18, 2026). Stock/crypto prices move daily; SNDK’s enormous gain (~39× cost) is the single largest asset and is volatile.	Used the provided prices as instructed. Actual sale proceeds will differ slightly — another reason to **sell immediately** rather than risk the SNDK windfall evaporating. The Day-1 math flexes automatically: whatever settles, pay in the stated order.
7	**Taxes are estimates.** Capital-gains (≈ $4,707) and income-tax (≈ $12,518/yr) figures use 2026 single-filer federal rules and the documents’ “pre-tax” salary note; VA disability treated as tax-free per federal law; WA has no state income tax.	A $4,800 reserve (slightly above the estimate) is set aside on Day 1. Advisor/CPA should confirm exact cost-basis lots at sale time. Three positions (WDC, PLTR, one NVDA lot) turn long-term on Aug 14, 2026; waiting would save only ≈ $300 in tax while ≈ $7,100 sits exposed to market swings as 19–21% interest accrues — selling now is still recommended.
8	**Minor data quirks.** Index-fund dates carry unexplained asterisks (Oct 2018*, Jan 2020**, Feb 2021**, Aug 2023***); share counts are marked approximate (“~”); the emergency-fund size ($2,000) is an advisor judgment call, not a client instruction.	Asterisks appear cosmetic — values are internally consistent, so figures were used as given. Holding more emergency cash would delay the finish; less would raise the risk of re-borrowing. Review with client.

Disclaimer: This roadmap is an AI-generated document prepared as **decision support** for a licensed financial professional at Alber Joe's Financial Advising. It is **not formal financial, tax, or legal advice**. All figures are estimates based on the documents provided and the prices quoted therein; actual market values, taxes, interest accrual, and payoff amounts will vary. A qualified advisor should verify all account details, balances, minimum payments, and tax treatment with the relevant institutions before any action is taken.